Seven consulting deck styles, side by side

How McKinsey-, BCG-, Bain-, Deloitte-, Accenture-, KPMG- and PwC-style decks differ in storyline, headline, colour, visuals and density



20-page comparison · October 2026

The seven styles share one grammar but differ in how loudly they argue, and in how much evidence they show

7
styles compared across six dimensions

3
families: strategy, Big Four advisory, tech transformation

1
constant: one message per slide, sourced and quantified

Strategy houses lead with the answer. McKinsey, BCG and Bain use full-sentence headlines, one message per slide and sparse, chart-led pages; they differ in accent (blue, green, red) and in favourite device (issue tree, 2x2, bridge).

Big Four decks lead with traceability. Deloitte, KPMG and PwC show scope, approach, findings and ratings, so tables, legends and roadmaps are normal and detail moves to the appendix.

Accenture-style decks lead with the build. Journeys, architecture stacks and wave roadmaps turn strategy into something that looks deliverable.

We compare each style on six dimensions that a reader notices within seconds

1 Storyline

How the argument is ordered: answer first, or context first

2 Headline

Voice and length of the slide title

3 Colour and type

Accent, background, font size and contrast

4 Visuals

Preferred charts, frameworks and diagrams

5 Density

Words and detail per slide; role of the appendix

6 Best use

Audience and decision the style fits

At a glance: each style has a signature colour, a signature opening and a signature device

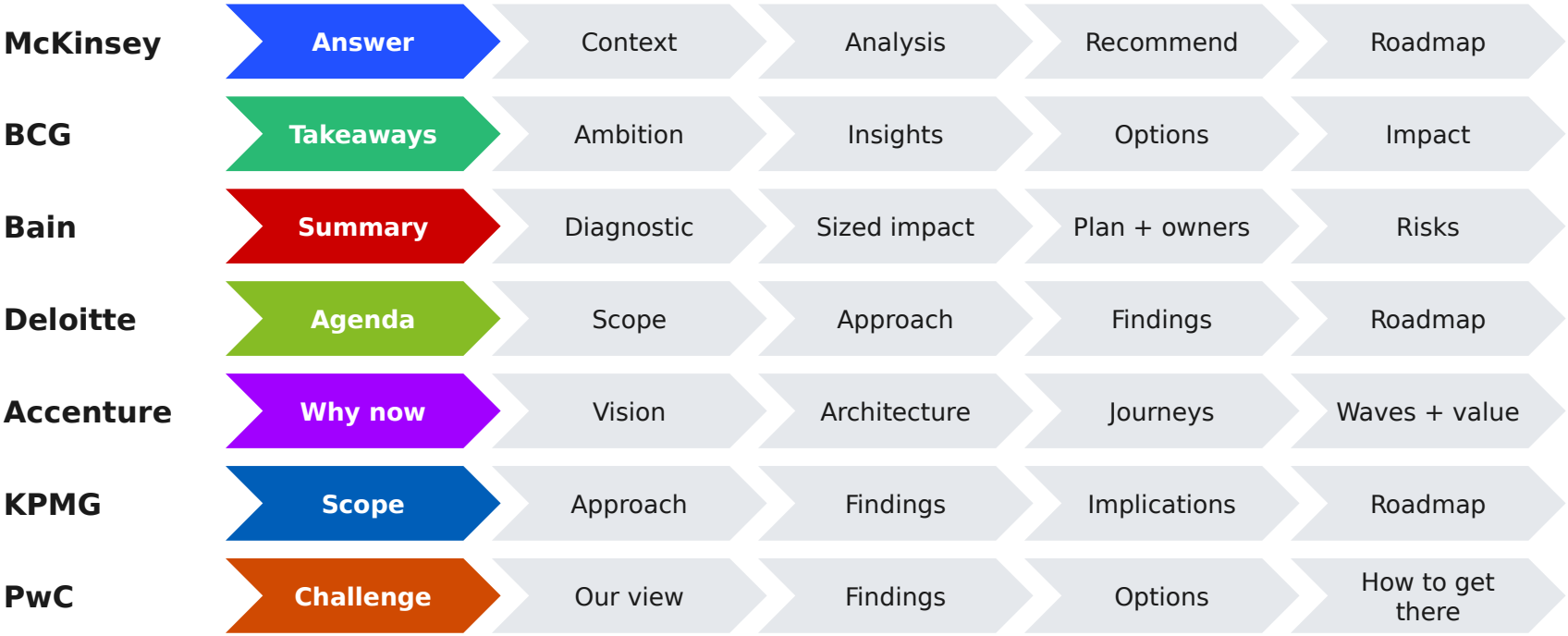
Style	Family	Accent	Opens with	Signature device
McKinsey-style	Strategy		Executive summary with the answer	Issue tree, 2x2, waterfall
BCG-style	Strategy		Key takeaways and a point of view	Framework matrix, takeaway box
Bain-style	Strategy		Result and sized impact	Value bridge, 90-day plan
Deloitte-style	Big Four		Agenda, scope and approach	RAG status, maturity model
Accenture-style	Tech transformation		Why change now and the vision	Journey map, architecture stack
KPMG-style	Big Four		Scope, approach, key findings	Ratings legend, control heat map
PwC-style	Big Four		Challenge and our view	Stat callout, takeaways box

Colour is the fastest tell: one dominant accent per firm, with greys doing the structural work

McKinsey	#2251FF	*Answer-first*	
BCG	#29BA74	*Insight + framework*	
Bain	#CC0000	*Results + impact*	
Deloitte	#86BC25	*Methodical*	
Accenture	#A100FF	*Journey + architecture*	
KPMG	#005EB8	*Evidence + risk*	
PwC	#D04A02	*Practical outcomes*	

Swatches: base · accent · support · tint · grey. Hex values are approximate.

Storylines diverge early: strategy decks conclude first, Big Four decks establish scope first



Highlighted first step marks where each style starts the argument.

Consulting deck styles compared · illustrative content · no logos or trademarks

The same finding gets a different headline voice in each style

Style	Illustrative headline	Voice
McKinsey	Localising bracket supply cuts lead time by more than half within 18 months	*Full-sentence 'so what', quantified*
BCG	Local supply turns a cost problem into a capability: lead time halves when suppliers are certified	*Insight with an idea, sentence case*
Bain	Lead time falls 54%, worth an estimated $40M a year, if five suppliers qualify by Q2	*Result and number first*
Deloitte	Finding 3: lead time for imported brackets is materially above the local benchmark	*Descriptive, finding-numbered*
Accenture	Reinvent the supply chain with a certified local supplier platform	*Forward-looking, active verb*
KPMG	Dependence on a single import source is a high-rated risk; local qualification reduces it	*Measured, risk-rated*
PwC	54% shorter lead times are achievable when local suppliers meet certified standards	*Key message with a statistic*

All numbers are illustrative and used only to show headline voice.

Type and layout rules are close; the differences lie in contrast and in how dividers are treated

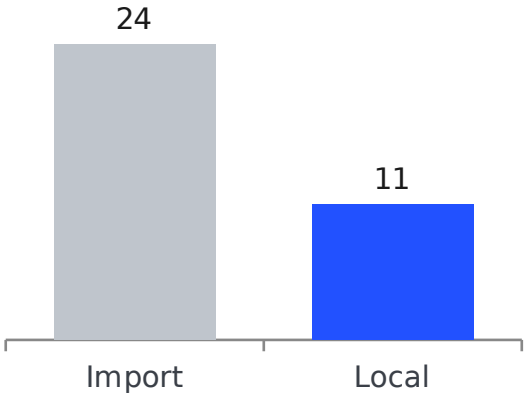
Style	Title	Body	Background	Dividers and emphasis
McKinsey	24–28 pt, navy	12–16 pt	White	Thin rules, one highlight box
BCG	~24 pt, left	12–14 pt	White	Shaded takeaway box, chevrons
Bain	~24 pt, charcoal	12–14 pt	White	Takeaway bar, big number
Deloitte	24–28 pt	12–14 pt	Dark dividers, light content	Large numbered dividers
Accenture	28+ pt	12–14 pt	White with black hero slides	Full-bleed dark statements
KPMG	~24 pt, left	12–14 pt	White, blue dividers	Blue dividers, thin rules
PwC	24–28 pt	12–14 pt	White, accent blocks	Colour-block dividers, stat callouts

Common rules: clean sans-serif, no 3D, no clip-art, source line in small grey text, slide number bottom right.

Chart idioms differ: highlight one bar, bridge the change, or rate the status

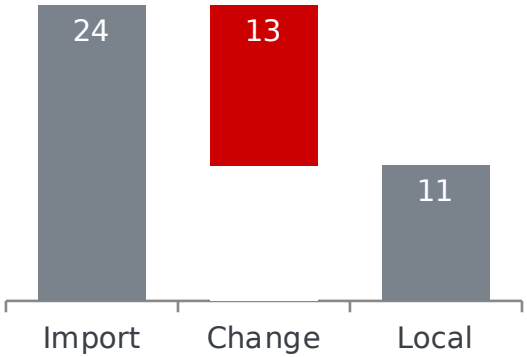
McKinsey-style

Key bar in accent, rest grey; direct labels, no gridlines



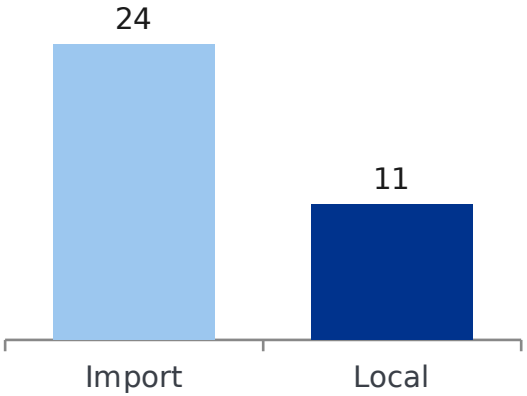
Bain-style

Bridge from current to target; the change in red



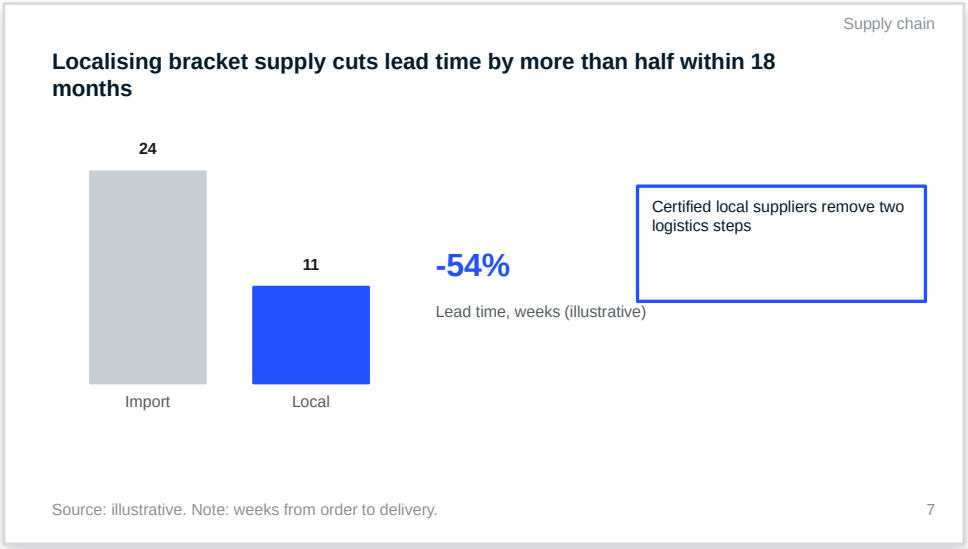
KPMG / Deloitte-style

Blue tints, darkest for the key series; RAG only for status



Lead time in weeks, illustrative data. Bain-style bridge: grey import level, red reduction of 13 weeks, local level.

McKinsey-style: the answer comes first and every title is a full sentence



Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Strategy | **Answer-first**

Storyline

Executive summary states the recommendation, then three MECE arguments; titles alone tell the story.

Visual language

White page, deep navy titles, one bright blue accent; one chart, one message; direct labels, no gridlines.

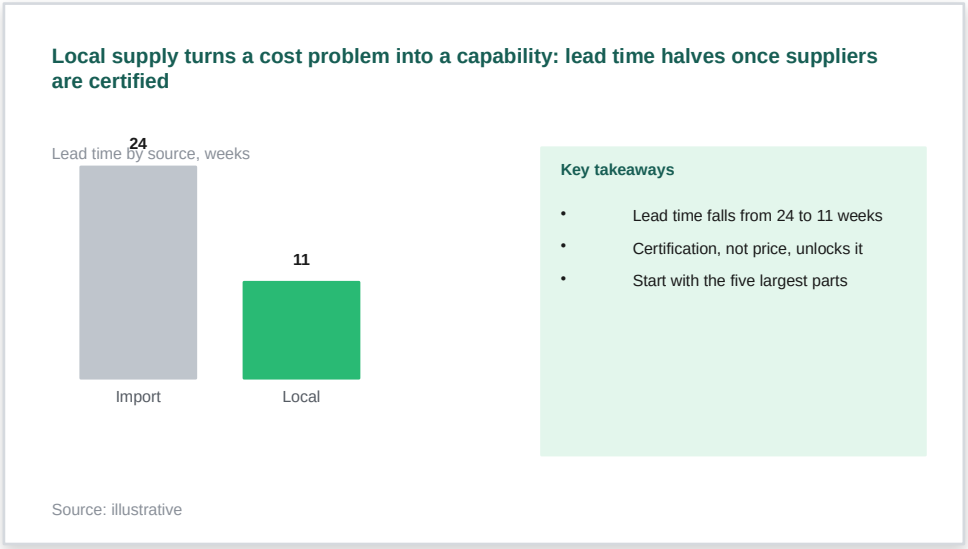
Rules to remember

One message per slide; every number has unit, period and source; at most five bullets, ideally none.

Use when

Board and CEO decisions where the logic must be audited at a glance.

BCG-style: a point of view proven by a memorable framework and a takeaway box



Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Strategy | **Insight + framework**

Storyline

Hypothesis-driven: key takeaways first, then insights, options and a recommended path.

Visual language

Dark and bright green, greys; 2x2s, archetypes, bubble charts; shaded takeaway panel beside the chart.

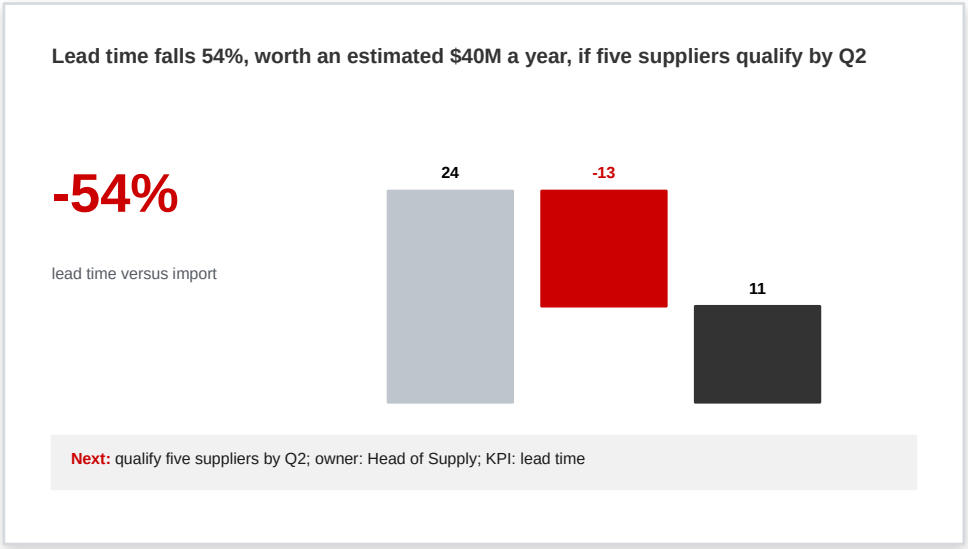
Rules to remember

Each slide holds an insight, proof and a 'so what'; compare options on consistent criteria with Harvey balls.

Use when

Strategy and growth choices where a big idea must stick.

Bain-style: lead with the result, size the impact and name the owner



Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Strategy | **Results + impact**

Storyline

Results-first: summary, diagnostic, sized recommendation, plan with owners and KPIs, risks.

Visual language

White, charcoal text, a single red accent; bridges and waterfalls; bold number callouts; bottom takeaway bar.

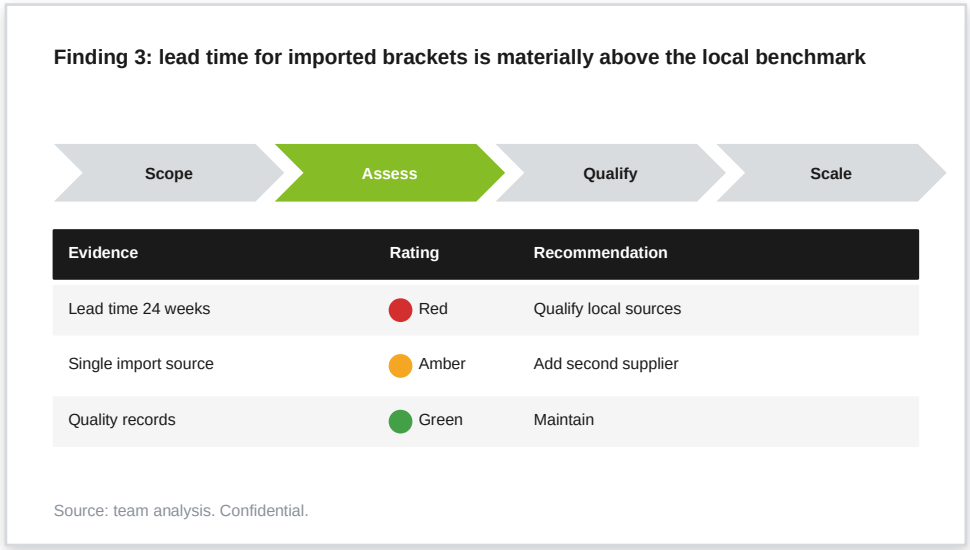
Rules to remember

Quantify baseline, target and delta; separate facts from judgment; implementation slides name owners and dates.

Use when

Performance, cost and value-creation work where the number is the story.

Deloitte-style: structure and traceability, with RAG status and maturity models



Finding 3: lead time for imported brackets is materially above the local benchmark

Scope | Assess | Qualify | Scale

Evidence	Rating	Recommendation
Lead time 24 weeks	Red	Qualify local sources
Single import source	Amber	Add second supplier
Quality records	Green	Maintain

Source: team analysis. Confidential.

Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Big Four **Methodical**

Storyline

Context, approach, findings, recommendations, roadmap, governance; scope and assumptions are shown.

Visual language

Black and white with vivid green; dark section dividers; chevron processes, RACI, heat maps, clean tables.

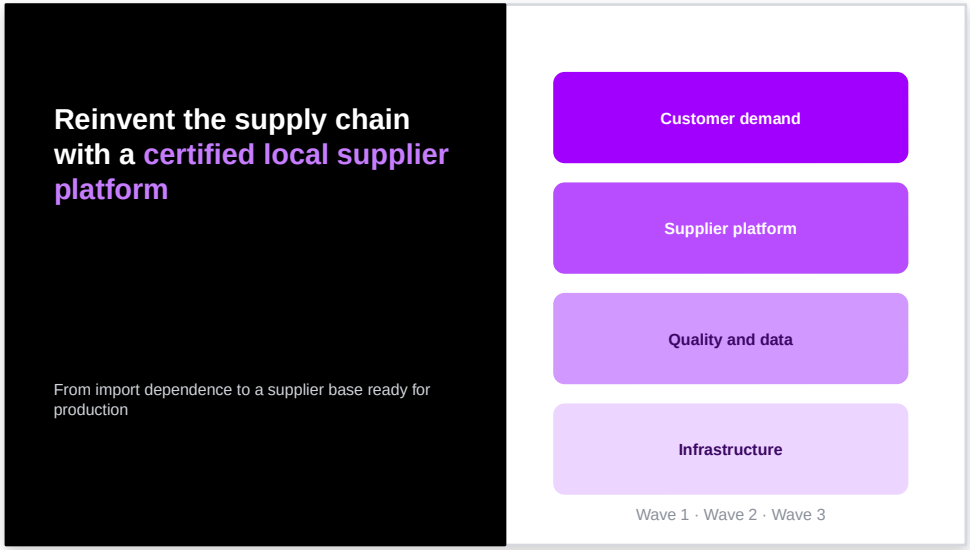
Rules to remember

Link each finding to evidence and a recommendation; define RAG and maturity legends; detail goes to the appendix.

Use when

Steering committees and programmes that need methodical, auditable detail.

Accenture-style: a bold vision made concrete with architecture, journeys and waves



Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Tech transformation **Journey + architecture**

Storyline

Why change now, vision, capabilities, architecture, journeys, wave roadmap, value case.

Visual language

Black, white and purple; hero statements in large type; layered stacks, journey maps, capability heat maps.

Rules to remember

Show what it looks like; tie every technology element to an outcome and metric; plan in waves with dependencies.

Use when

Digital and technology transformations that move from strategy to delivery.

KPMG-style: measured findings with ratings, controls and a phased roadmap



Dependence on a single import source is a high-rated risk; local qualification reduces it

Findings are rated High, Medium or Low against the defined scale.

Finding	Risk	Recommendation
Single import source	High	Qualify two local suppliers
Long lead time	High	Certification gates
Quality records	Low	Maintain controls

Source: team analysis. Assumes data as provided; ratings are indicative.

Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Big Four | **Evidence + risk**

Storyline

Situation, scope and approach, key findings, implications, recommendations, roadmap, governance.

Visual language

Deep blue anchor with blue tints; blue dividers with large numerals; tables, maturity and control assessments.

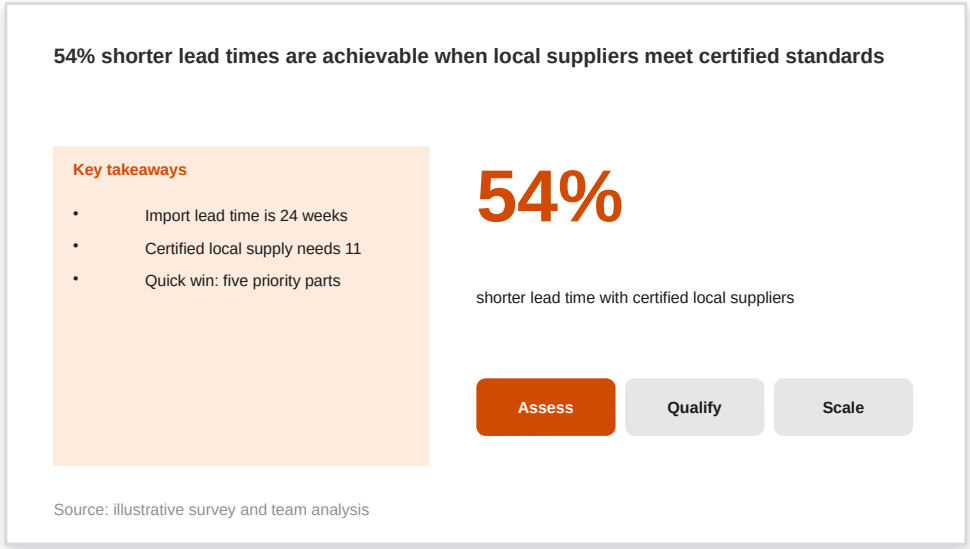
Rules to remember

Define rating scales in a legend; state assumptions and limitations; each recommendation maps to a finding.

Use when

Board, audit committee and risk or compliance audiences.

PwC-style: practical outcomes, statistic callouts and takeaways boxes



Illustrative page in this style (same finding, invented data)

Big Four | **Practical outcomes**

Storyline

Challenge, our view, what it means, what to do, how to get there; benchmarks and surveys back claims.

Visual language

White with orange and coral accents; large stat callouts in accent colour; colour-block dividers; flat icons.

Rules to remember

Open each section with a takeaways box (three bullets max); cite source and sample size; concise phrases.

Use when

Advisory and deals work where benchmarks and a clear next step persuade.

Scorecard: strategy styles score high on impact and sparseness, Big Four styles on traceability

Style	Quantified impact	Framework / concept	Traceability	Visual boldness	Text per slide	Delivery focus
McKinsey	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●○○○
BCG	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●○○○	●●○○○
Bain	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●●○○
Deloitte	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●●●	●●○○○	●●●●○	●●●●○
Accenture	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●●●	●●○○○	●●●●●
KPMG	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●●●●	●●○○○	●●●●○	●●●●○
PwC	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●●○

Ratings (1–5 dots) are our qualitative reading of style conventions, not measured data. Text per slide: more dots, more text.

Positioning map: the styles spread along two axes, concept versus evidence and sparse versus detailed



Approximate positions based on documented style conventions.

Choose the style by audience and decision: each situation has a best fit

If the audience needs…	Lean toward	Because
A fast decision from a CEO or board	**McKinsey**	Answer-first titles let them read only the headlines
A memorable idea for a strategic choice	**BCG**	Frameworks and takeaway boxes make the logic stick
A sized business case with owners	**Bain**	Bridges and big numbers put the value on one page
Audit-ready findings and a controls view	**KPMG**	Rating legends and finding-to-recommendation mapping
A programme plan with status and roles	**Deloitte**	RAG, maturity and RACI layouts show detail cleanly
A concrete digital target state	**Accenture**	Architecture stacks and journeys show what it looks like
Persuasion with benchmarks and next steps	**PwC**	Stat callouts and takeaways boxes carry the case

Mixing is normal: many teams use an answer-first spine with Big Four-style findings tables in the appendix.

What all seven share, and how to apply a style with the skills in this folder

Shared DNA

- One message per slide, with a full-sentence title
- Every figure carries unit, period and source
- One accent colour; greys for structure
- Clean sans-serif, no 3D or clip-art
- Detail moves to the appendix

How to apply a style

1. **Pick the style**
   Use the choosing guide on page 19.

2. **Load its skill**
   Copy the folder from consulting-deck-skills into ~/.claude/skills/.

3. **Draft titles first**
   Write the story as headlines, then build visuals and check sources.

Styles are emulated from public conventions; colours are approximate and no firm logos or trademarks are used.